

PMBOK / PMI | PMB-20

Communications Management Plan

What is communicated, to whom, by whom, when and how

Meridian Group

Programme Helios — Infrastructure and Platform Stack for AI GPU Compute at Scale

Field	Detail
Document title	Communications Management Plan
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Project / Programme	<i>Helios Tranche 2 — Scale Build</i>
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Date	<i>18 Sep 2026</i>
Author	<i>D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager</i>
Owner	<i>Project manager</i>
Approver	<i>Sponsor</i>
Classification	<i>Internal</i>
Retention	<i>7 years from programme closure</i>

Document control

Version history

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change
0.1	04 Jun 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Initial draft
0.2	21 Jul 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Updated following workstream lead review
1.0	18 Sep 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate

Reviewers

Name	Role	Review scope	Date reviewed
T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect	Chief Platform Architect	Technical content and solution alignment	08 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Security, assurance and residency content	10 Sep 2026
C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner	Finance Business Partner	Cost, funding and benefit figures	11 Sep 2026
M. Verity, Head of P3O	Head of P3O	Governance standards and completeness	15 Sep 2026

Approval

This product is baselined once approval is recorded below. Any subsequent change must go through change control.

Name	Role	Decision	Date
R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Senior Responsible Owner / Group CTO	Approved	18 Sep 2026
H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure	Director of Infrastructure	Approved	18 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Approved subject to closure of ISS-003	18 Sep 2026

Related products

Reference	Product	Relationship
PMB-04	Stakeholder Register	Source of communication requirements
PMB-05	Stakeholder Engagement Plan	Engagement actions delivered through communications
PMB-28	Work Performance Report	A key scheduled communication

How to use this template

Aspect	Guidance
Purpose	Defines the project's communication approach — the information needs of each stakeholder group, the format, channel, frequency and owner of each communication, and how communication effectiveness will be assessed.
Framework	PMBOK / PMI — Communications Management — Plan Communications Management
Created when	During planning, after the stakeholder register
Reviewed / updated	At each phase boundary
Owner	Project manager
Approver	Sponsor
Format options	Document, presentation, register entry, or tool record — the content matters, not the medium.
Tailoring	Match the communication to the decision it supports. A report nobody acts on is a cost with no benefit — remove it.

This is a worked example. Every field has been completed with illustrative content for Programme Helios, a fictional AI GPU infrastructure and platform programme. All example content is shown in grey italic — the black text is the template itself. Replace the grey italic content with your own.

Quality criteria

Use these to check the product is fit for purpose before submitting it for approval.

- Every communication has a named owner and a stated purpose
- Content is matched to the audience's decision needs, not to what is convenient to produce
- Escalation routes and timeframes are explicit
- Confidentiality and classification requirements are addressed
- Effectiveness is reviewed and unread communications are stopped

Contents

Document control..... 2

 Version history..... 2

 Reviewers..... 2

 Approval..... 2

 Related products..... 3

How to use this template..... 4

 Quality criteria..... 4

1. Communication requirements analysis..... 6

2. Communication matrix..... 6

3. Escalation routes..... 8

4. Meeting schedule..... 9

5. Glossary and terminology..... 10

6. Communication constraints..... 11

7. Effectiveness review..... 11

1. Communication requirements analysis

Stakeholder / group	Information needed	Decision it supports	Level of detail	Preferred channel	Frequency
Programme Board	Written pack with a one-page exception summary first	Whether to accept forecast variance and release the next funding tranche	Exception-based, one page per workstream	Circulated by email 48 hours ahead, discussed in the meeting	Monthly
Programme Manager	Structured template — progress, next, risks, asks	Where to direct programme management attention this week	Activity level	Collaboration platform form	Weekly
Scrum Masters and Product Owners	Board walkthrough with actions recorded live	Which dependencies need escalation this week	Feature and dependency level	Video call with the shared program board	Weekly
ART, Business Owners, tenant representatives	Live demonstration from the staging cluster	Whether the increment is on track against PI objectives	Working software only, no slides	Hybrid session, recorded	Each iteration
Researcher and data scientist community	Short bulletin with links to training	Not a decision communication — adoption support	Non-technical, task-focused	Email and the AI community channel	Fortnightly
Group executive committee	One-page dashboard with RAG, spend and benefit position	Whether portfolio-level intervention is required	Initiative level only	Portfolio reporting site	Monthly
CISO, Group Risk, Internal Audit	Findings report with severity and remediation status	Whether the platform may proceed to multi-tenant go-live	Finding level with evidence references	Secure document share	At each assurance milestone
SRO, Finance, benefit owners	Benefit-by-benefit position against baseline and target	Whether corrective action is needed to protect the benefit	Benefit level with measure source	Programme reporting site	Quarterly

2. Communication matrix

Ref	Communication	Purpose	Audience	Owner	Format	Channel	Frequency	Classification
Carried forward	e.g. Steering committee pack	Decision-making on exceptions, changes and gate progression	Programme Board	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Written pack with a one-page	Circulated by email 48 hours ahead,	Monthly	Internal

Ref	Communication	Purpose	Audience	Owner	Format	Channel	Frequency	Classification
rd from the Tranc he 1 lesso ns regist er					exception summary first	discussed in the meeting		
CM-02	Workstream status return	Surface impediments and dependency changes early	Programme Manager	Workstream leads	Structured template — progress, next, risks, asks	Collaboration platform form	Weekly	Internal
CM-03	ART sync record	Coordinate dependencies and impediments across the seven teams	Scrum Masters and Product Owners	D. Okonkwo, Release Train Engineer	Board walkthrough with actions recorded live	Video call with the shared program board	Weekly	Internal
CM-04	System demo	Demonstrate working, integrated increment to stakeholders	ART, Business Owners, tenant representatives	System Team	Live demonstration from the staging cluster	Hybrid session, recorded	Each iteration	Internal
CM-05	Tenant onboarding bulletin	Prepare researchers for the change in how they access compute	Researcher and data scientist community	F. Mansour, Business Change Lead	Short bulletin with links to training	Email and the AI community channel	Fortnightly	Internal
CM-06	Executive dashboard	Give the Group executive a single view of portfolio health	Group executive committee	M. Verity, Head of P3O	One-page dashboard with RAG, spend and benefit position	Portfolio reporting site	Monthly	Confidential
CM-	Security assurance	Evidence that controls	CISO, Group Risk,	Cordant	Findings	Secure	At each	Confidential

Ref	Communication	Purpose	Audience	Owner	Format	Channel	Frequency	Classification
07	report	operate as designed	Internal Audit	Assurance	report with severity and remediation status	document share	assurance milestone	
CM-08	Benefit tracking report	Show whether the case is being realised	SRO, Finance, benefit owners	V. Chandra, Head of AI Enablement	Benefit-by-benefit position against baseline and target	Programme reporting site	Quarterly	Internal
CM-09	Programme Board pack	Decision-making on exceptions, changes and gate progression	Programme Board	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Written pack with a one-page exception summary first	Circulated by email 48 hours ahead, discussed in the meeting	Monthly	Internal

3. Escalation routes

Trigger	Escalate to	Within	Method	Recorded in
Tolerance breach forecast	Delegated to the Programme Manager within the agreed tolerance	Applies from hall A handover; hall B follows in Tranche 2 closure	Dashboard published to the programme site	Solution intent wiki, DXB-1 platform space
Unresolved issue affecting critical path	Programme objectives cannot be met without resolution — response within four hours, escalated to the SRO immediately	Programme objectives cannot be met without resolution — response within four hours, escalated to the	Programme objectives cannot be met without resolution — response within four hours, escalated to the SRO immediately	Programme objectives cannot be met without resolution — response within four hours, escalated to the SRO immediately

Trigger	Escalate to	Within	Method	Recorded in
		<i>SRO immediately</i>		
Risk materialising above threshold	<i>No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance</i>	<i>No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance</i>	<i>No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance</i>	<i>No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance</i>
Security incident	<i>Handled through the Agile Release Train rather than the predictive workstreams</i>	<i>Maintained by the P3O as part of the assurance evidence library</i>	<i>Workshop with the affected workstream leads</i>	<i>Configuration management database</i>
Supplier failure	<i>Parallel storage vendor</i>	<i>Accelerator vendor (direct)</i>	<i>Automated report from the observability platform</i>	<i>Assurance evidence pack, Tranche 2 gate</i>

4. Meeting schedule

Meeting	Purpose	Chair	Attendees	Frequency	Duration	Outputs
<i>Programme Board pack</i>	<i>Decision-making on exceptions, changes and gate progression</i>	<i>D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager</i>	<i>Programme Board</i>	<i>Monthly</i>	<i>60 minutes</i>	<i>Decision-making on exceptions, changes and gate progression</i>
<i>Workstream status return</i>	<i>Surface impediments and dependency changes early</i>	<i>Workstream leads</i>	<i>Programme Manager</i>	<i>Weekly</i>	<i>2 hours</i>	<i>Surface impediments and dependency changes early</i>
<i>ART sync record</i>	<i>Coordinate dependencies and impediments across the seven teams</i>	<i>D. Okonkwo, Release Train Engineer</i>	<i>Scrum Masters and Product Owners</i>	<i>Weekly</i>	<i>3 working days</i>	<i>Coordinate dependencies and impediments across the seven teams</i>
<i>System demo</i>	<i>Demonstrate working, integrated increment to stakeholders</i>	<i>System Team</i>	<i>ART, Business Owners, tenant representatives</i>	<i>Each iteration</i>	<i>10 working days</i>	<i>Demonstrate working, integrated increment to stakeholders</i>

Meeting	Purpose	Chair	Attendees	Frequency	Duration	Outputs
Tenant onboarding bulletin	Prepare researchers for the change in how they access compute	F. Mansour, Business Change Lead	Researcher and data scientist community	Fortnightly	4 weeks	Prepare researchers for the change in how they access compute
Executive dashboard	Give the Group executive a single view of portfolio health	M. Verity, Head of P3O	Group executive committee	Monthly	90 days	Give the Group executive a single view of portfolio health
Security assurance report	Evidence that controls operate as designed	Cordant Assurance	CISO, Group Risk, Internal Audit	At each assurance milestone	60 minutes	Evidence that controls operate as designed

5. Glossary and terminology

Common terms and acronyms used in project communications, so that stakeholders read the same meaning.

Term	Meaning
Accelerator	A GPU or equivalent processor used for AI training and inference workloads
All-reduce	A collective communication operation that aggregates results across all participating GPUs; its efficiency largely determines distributed training throughput
CDU	Coolant distribution unit — transfers heat between the facility water loop and the rack liquid cooling loop
DXB-1 / AUH-2	The programme's primary Dubai data centre and the planned second site in Abu Dhabi
Fair-share quota	A scheduling policy under which each tenant receives a configured proportion of contended capacity
NCCL	The collective communication library used to benchmark and tune fabric performance
PUE	Power usage effectiveness — total facility energy divided by IT energy
Rear-door heat exchanger	A liquid-cooled door fitted to a rack that removes heat at the point of generation

6. Communication constraints

Constraint	Source	Effect on communications
Floor loading in hall B limited to 1,400 kg per rack position	Programme SharePoint — Helios / Tranche 2 / Governance	Programme Board pack
Grid capacity at DXB-1 is capped at 6.2 MVA until 2028	Solution intent wiki, DXB-1 platform space	Workstream status return
Restricted training data must remain within UAE borders	ALM tool — Helios ART board	ART sync record
No production change during the Group financial close window	Assurance evidence pack, Tranche 2 gate	System demo

7. Effectiveness review

Communication ref	Is it read?	Does it drive action?	Feedback	Decision
ART sync record	On-call rota cannot be sustained beyond a 5x8 model at handover	Secure written migration commitments from three business units	Amber — recovery action agreed with the workstream lead and tracked weekly	Approved
Programme Board pack	Hall A capacity capped at 1,536 GPUs until resolved	Run two live coolant-leak drills before hall A handover	Dependent on the Enterprise Identity Programme; outside programme control	Rejected
Weekly workstream status return	Critical path delay of up to ten weeks and a quarter of deferred benefit	Confirm vendor allocation in writing before placing the structural order	Escalated to the Programme Board on 18 Sep 2026; decision requested	Deferred to the next Board
Tranche 2 gate evidence pack	Reportable data incident and loss of regulatory standing	Enforce mutual TLS on the cluster API and retest by 22 Sep 2026	Improved since last period following the CDU set-point retune	Approved with conditions

